

Karthik P

Cybersecurity Researcher | Penetration Tester

Malappuram, Kerala, India

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Professional Summary

Cybersecurity Researcher and Penetration Tester with hands-on expertise in network security, Active Directory exploitation, web application security, and vulnerability assessment. Skilled in red team techniques, CTF machine development, and building vulnerable lab environments for security research and training. Seeking an entry-level cybersecurity position to apply technical knowledge in real-world environments.

Technical Skills

- **Penetration Testing:** Network Pentesting, Web Application Pentesting, Active Directory
- **Web Application Security:** OWASP Top 10, SQL Injection, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, IDOR, SSTI,
- **Active Directory:** Kerberoasting, AS-REP Roasting, Pass-the-Hash, GPO Abuse, Ticket Attacks
- **Programming & Scripting:** Python, Bash

Tools

- | | | | |
|--------------|-----------|------------|------------|
| • Nmap | • Hashcat | • Nuclei | • Mimikatz |
| • Metasploit | • Hydra | • Nessus | • Gobuster |
| • Burp Suite | • SQLMap | • Impacket | • FFUF |
| • Wireshark | • Nikto | • Kerbrute | • LinPEAS |

Professional Experience

Research And Development Member

July 2025 – Present

Offenso Hackers Academy

- Design, deploy, and maintain Dockerized CTF challenges and vulnerable lab environments across varied network topologies, supporting the organization's security lab infrastructure and internal services.
- Build and troubleshoot CTF infrastructure, vulnerable machines, network configurations, and containerized environments for events and assessment programs.
- Develop challenge backends, custom security tools, and internal automation scripts using Python, MySQL, Docker, and Linux to streamline lab deployment and maintenance workflows.
- Conduct technical research in web application security, network exploitation, Linux, and Active Directory attack paths to inform new challenge design.

Junior Cybersecurity Intern

June - July 2026

Hackware Security Solutions

- Gained hands-on experience performing vulnerability assessment and penetration testing across web, network, and mobile platforms
- Conducted Active Directory penetration testing and developed detailed vapt reports of vulnerabilities.

Projects

Custom Vulnerable Machines and CTF Challenges – ctf-hackbegin.vercel.app

- Designed and deployed custom CTF challenges and vulnerable machines simulating real-world attack scenarios across web exploitation, privilege escalation, and network-based attack vectors.
- Implemented vulnerable web environments to demonstrate chained OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities.
- Documented challenge walkthroughs and attack paths for learning and reinforce pentesting methodologies.

lxd2root - exploit(CVE-2023-5536) – github.com/karthikparambil/lxd2root

- A privilege escalation exploit targeting LXD group misconfiguration on Linux, To escape container and achieve root access from a low-privileged lxd user.

Education

Bachelor of Computer Science (BCA)

2026 – Present

Yenepoya University

Advanced Diploma in Information Security(ADIS)

2025 – 2026

Offenso Hackers Academy, Calicut

Certifications

- CompTIA Pentest+ (pursuing)
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate
- Advanced Diploma in Information Security (ADIS)
- Certified Cybersecurity Educator Professional (CCEP)